

Word family: **appeal / appeals / appealed / appealing / appealingly**

Base word: appeal

Forms: appeals, appealed, appealing

Related form: appealingly

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / related adjective and adverb uses (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “I find that **appealing** because I enjoy books that do more than pass the time...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **appealing** means **attractive, interesting, or pleasing in a way that makes you want something or like the idea of it**.

繁體中文：***有吸引力的；令人感興趣的；讓人產生好感或想接近 / 嘗試的**

中文翻譯：

> “I find that **appealing**...”

「我覺得那一點很**吸引人 / 很有吸引力**.....」

Here:

appealing = 這種想法或特點讓人產生興趣、好感或想進一步了解

1. **appeal = attract or interest someone (吸引) — 吸引；引起興趣**

This is the core meaning behind your passage.

Meaning: To be attractive or interesting to someone.

Practice 1

> “Books that challenge my thinking really **appeal** to me.”

「能挑戰我思維的書真的很**吸引**我。」

Practice 2

> “The idea of studying abroad **appeals** to her.”

「出國留學這個想法很**吸引**她。」

****appeal to someone = 對某人有吸引力；令某人感興趣****

Common:

- * appeal to readers
- * appeal to children
- * appeal to a wide audience
- * appeal to me

This is the sense underlying ****appealing**** in your passage.

2. ****appealing = attractive / pleasant / interesting (有吸引力的) — 吸引人的；討喜的****

****Appealing**** is the adjective form most directly relevant to your sentence.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I find that ****appealing****.”

「我覺得那很****吸引人****。」

Practice 4

> “The idea sounds very ****appealing****.”

「這個想法聽起來很****吸引人****。」

Practice 5

> “The restaurant has a warm and ****appealing**** atmosphere.”

「那間餐廳有一種溫暖而****吸引人的****氣氛。」

****appealing = 令人感到有吸引力、有好感或願意接近 / 接受的****

This belongs to Meaning 1 rather than being a separate core sense.

3. ****appeal = make a serious request for help/support (呼籲) — 呼籲；懇求****

****Appeal**** can mean to make an earnest or public request.

Practice 6

> “The charity ****appealed**** for donations.”

「慈善機構****呼籲****大家捐款。」

Practice 7

> “The police ****appealed**** to the public for information.”

「警方****呼籲****公眾提供資料。」

****appeal for something = 公開或認真地呼籲、請求人們提供某物****

Common:

- * appeal for help
- * appeal for calm
- * appeal for information
- * appeal to the public

This is a major distinct verb meaning.

4. ****appeal = ask formally for a legal decision to be changed (法律) — 上訴****

****Appeal**** has a very important legal meaning.

Practice 8

> “He decided to ****appeal**** the decision.”

「他決定對該裁決提出****上訴****。」

Practice 9

> “The company ****appealed**** against the ruling.”

「公司對該裁決提出了****上訴****。」

****appeal = 正式要求法院或其他權力機構重新審視並更改原來的決定****

Common:

- * appeal a decision
- * appeal against a ruling
- * appeal to a higher court

This is genuinely distinct from attraction or public requests.

5. **appeal = request a higher authority to reconsider (正式申訴) — 申訴；要求覆核**

Outside strict court contexts, **appeal** can also mean asking a higher authority to reconsider a decision.

Practice 10

> “Students can **appeal** their exam results.”

「學生可以就考試成績提出**申訴 / 覆核**。」

Practice 11

> “She **appealed** against the university’s decision.”

「她對大學的決定提出**申訴**。」

appeal = 向較高層級正式要求重新考慮某項決定

For core counting, I would merge this with the legal sense because the same mental concept applies:

> asking a higher authority to reconsider a decision.

6. **appeal = rely on an idea/value/emotion to persuade (訴諸) — 訴諸；打動**

Appeal to can mean to try to persuade someone by using a particular principle, emotion, or value.

Practice 12

> “The speaker **appealed to** the audience’s sense of fairness.”

「講者**訴諸**觀眾的公平感。」

Practice 13

> “The campaign **appealed to** people’s emotions.”

「這場宣傳活動**訴諸** / 打動**人們**的情感。」

appeal to something = 利用某種價值、情緒、原則或感受來影響 / 說服人

This is distinct from simply “be attractive to.”

Compare:

> “The idea appeals to me.”

> = 這個想法吸引我。

> “He appealed to my sympathy.”

> = 他訴諸我的同情心。

7. **appeal** = request urgently/directly to a person (向某人懇求) — 懇求 ; 請求

A person can **appeal to someone to do something**.

Practice 14

> “They **appealed to** the government to act quickly.”

「他們**呼籲** / 懇請**政府**迅速採取行動。」

Practice 15

> “She **appealed to** him not to leave.”

「她**懇求**他不要離開。」

appeal to someone to do something = 鄭重或懇切地請求某人採取行動

This belongs to the request/plea branch rather than attraction.

8. **appeal** = attraction or attractiveness (名詞) — 吸引力 ; 魅力

As a noun, **appeal** can mean the quality that makes something attractive or interesting.

Practice 16

> “The city has strong international **appeal**.”

「這座城市具有很強的國際**吸引力**。」

Practice 17

> “Part of the book’s **appeal** is its simple style.”

「這本書其中一部分的**吸引力**在於它簡潔的風格。」

appeal = 令某人感到有興趣、有好感或想接近某物的特質

This is the noun counterpart of Meaning 1.

9. **appeal** = public request for help/support (名詞) — 呼籲；募捐呼籲

Practice 18

> “The organization launched an **appeal** for emergency aid.”

「該組織發起了一項緊急援助**呼籲**。」

Practice 19

> “The **appeal** raised a large amount of money.”

「這次**募捐呼籲**籌得了大量款項。」

appeal = 對公眾發出的正式或迫切請求

This is the noun version of Meaning 3.

10. **appeal** = legal challenge/review request (名詞) — 上訴；申訴

Practice 20

> “The court rejected his **appeal**.”

「法院駁回了他的**上訴**。」

Practice 21

> “She filed an **appeal** against the decision.”

「她針對該決定提出了**申訴 / 上訴**。」

appeal = 要求較高法院或權力機構重新審視原來決定的正式程序

This is the noun counterpart of Meaning 4.

Related form: **appealingly**

Appealingly means in an attractive or pleasant way.

Practice 22

> “The food was **appealingly** presented.”

「食物擺盤得很**吸引人**。」

appealingly = 以令人喜歡或感到有吸引力的方式

This is valid but lower frequency than **appealing**.

Important distinction: **appeal** vs **attract**

attract

means draw someone's attention or interest.

appeal

often emphasizes that something matches a person's tastes, preferences, values, or desires.

> “The advertisement attracted my attention.”

= 廣告吸引了我的注意。

> “The idea appeals to me.”

= 這個想法很合我心意 / 很吸引我。

So **appeal** often feels more subjective and preference-based.

Important distinction: **appeal vs interest**

interest

means make someone want to know more.

appeal

means make someone like, want, or feel positively toward something.

Something can interest you intellectually without strongly appealing to you.

Important distinction: **appealing vs attractive**

attractive

is broader and can describe:

- * physical appearance
- * offers
- * opportunities
- * ideas

appealing

often emphasizes:

- * pleasantness
- * charm
- * emotional or intellectual attraction

- > attractive person
- > appealing idea

There is substantial overlap.

Important distinction: **appealing vs compelling**

****appealing****

= attractive or likeable

****compelling****

= so convincing, powerful, or interesting that it strongly holds attention

A book can be appealing without necessarily being compelling.

Important distinction: ****appeal vs plead****

****plead****

usually emphasizes urgent or emotional begging.

****appeal****

can be formal, public, or dignified:

> appeal for help

> plead for mercy

****Appeal**** is broader and less necessarily desperate.

Important distinction: ****appeal vs request****

****request****

is neutral.

****appeal****

suggests a more serious, urgent, emotional, or public request.

> request information

> appeal for information

The second sounds more pressing.

Important distinction: ****appeal vs apply****

These are often confused in administrative contexts.

****apply****

= make an initial formal request/application

****appeal****

= challenge or ask for reconsideration after a decision has already been made

> apply for admission

> appeal an admission decision

Different stages.

Grammar note: ****appeal to****

****Appeal to**** has multiple patterns:

Attraction

> “The book appeals to young readers.”

= 這本書吸引年輕讀者。

Persuasion/value

> “He appealed to their sense of duty.”

= 他訴諸他們的責任感。

Request

> “They appealed to the government for help.”

= 他們向政府求助 / 呼籲政府提供協助。

So the same preposition ****to**** does not guarantee the same sense.

Countability note

****Appeal**** as a noun can be:

Uncountable-ish attraction sense

> “The product has broad appeal.”

「這產品有廣泛的吸引力。」

Countable request/legal sense

> an appeal for help

> an appeal against the decision

> several appeals

This distinction is useful.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****appeal****

* ****appeals****

* ****appealed****

* ****appealing****

* ****appealingly****

Useful constructions include:

* appeal to someone

* appeal for help

* appeal to someone to do something

* appeal against a decision

* appeal a ruling

* broad appeal

* public appeal

* legal appeal

The important curation point is that the same form ****appeal to**** can express very different concepts: attraction, persuasion through values/emotions, or earnest requests. These should not be merged merely because the grammar looks similar.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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appeal — attract	對某人有吸引力，使某人產生興趣或好感
appealing	令人感到有吸引力、討喜或值得接近 / 嘗試的
appeal — request/plea	鄭重、迫切或公開地呼籲 / 懇求某人提供協助或採取行動
appeal — legal/administrative	要求較高法院或權力機構重新審視某項決定；上訴 / 申訴
appeal to emotion/value	訴諸某種情感、原則或價值以影響或說服別人
appeal — noun, attractiveness	使人產生興趣、好感或想接近的吸引力
appeal — noun, request	正式或迫切的呼籲 / 請求
appeal — noun, legal	要求重新審理或覆核決定的正式上訴程序

For your original sentence

> “I find that ****appealing**** because I enjoy books that do more than pass the time...”

The exact meaning is:

****appealing = 那種特點令我覺得有吸引力、值得閱讀或進一步了解****

So:

> ****I find that appealing.****

= ****我覺得那一點很吸引人 / 很合我心意。****

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****appeal****:

1. ****attract / be attractive to someone****
2. ****make an earnest or public request****
3. ****formally challenge a decision / ask for reconsideration****
4. ****appeal to a value/emotion/principle in order to persuade****

I would keep noun ****appeal**** forms aligned with those same branches, and treat ****appealing / appealingly**** as family extensions rather than inflate the core count.